

The developer with a contribution gets the call.

From zero, through Rust, to your first real open-source contribution.

Three people apply for the same Rust job. All three can write Rust. All three have projects on their GitHub. One of them also has a **merged open-source contribution**: a real change, in software other people use, reviewed and accepted by strangers. That is the one who gets the call.

A personal project says: trust me. A merged contribution says: I did this, it is in the code people run, and my name is on it.

think gets you there. It teaches programming from true zero, up through Rust, in a way that actually sticks. Then it does what a certificate never can: it walks you into a real, merged, public open-source contribution of your own. Career-building proof, not a promise.

think is a reentry utility that teaches programming at a fundamental level; from 1s and 0s up through Rust, we help onboard justice-impacted individuals to the world of **open source** as a career-building initiative.

ONE-BREATH VARIANTS

Three ways to say the same position out loud (Penn, July 2026):

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out tangible contributions to open source as a catalyst to career growth.”

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out a range of contributions, from small doc changes up to full blown patches, which can directly impact hire-ability.”

“think teaches people coming home to program from 1’s and 0’s up through Rust, and every project ships in public, building out a range of different real world contributions, from doc changes up to real world drivers.”

WHAT YOU LEARN

Real programming from the ground up, through Rust. The fundamentals most bootcamp graduates never get, taught slowly enough that a true beginner can actually finish.

HOW IT STICKS

You do not just read and answer questions. You work the machine yourself, right in the browser, from a single bit up to a running program. Self-paced and mastery-based, so nobody is rushed and it cannot get stuck. No experience and no hardware required.

WHAT YOU SHIP

Not a certificate that says you attended. A real open-source contribution with your name on it, merged into software people use. The portfolio piece that is not just “trust me.”

WHAT THIS ACTUALLY GETS YOU

I am not going to oversell it. No beginner walks out of a course into a kernel job, and Rust roles are a smaller slice of the market than web. What think gives you is different, and honestly more useful at the start. You come out differentiated, with real work to show for it, a driver you wrote and contributions anyone can look up, and that opens a range of roles where knowing what is under the hood is rare and valued: embedded, systems, developer tooling, QA, technical support, plain software. The kernel is the ceiling, not the floor. This is not competing with the web bootcamps either. It is a different lane, for the people who want one.

WHY A CONTRIBUTION, NOT JUST A COURSE

Proof that survived review. Anyone can put a personal project on GitHub. A merged contribution was read, questioned, and accepted by people who did not have to be nice. That is weight a solo project cannot carry.

Evidence, not a claim. 83% of organizations weigh open-source contributions when they hire. A merged patch outweighs a gap in your history, because it is something they can actually check.

A record that does not ask about your past. The review judges the patch, not the person. Nobody asks where you have been. And the on-ramps already exist: kernelnewbies, the Linux Kernel Mentorship Program, Outreachy.

Start at zero. Finish with a contribution. You do not graduate with a promise; you graduate with something an employer can open and read.

Source: 2024 Open Source Software Funding Survey (GitHub, the Linux Foundation, and Harvard): 83% of organizations say open-source contribution is at least somewhat important for prospective hires.